JAYA HARSHA THIPPANA

Principal Data Scientist · AI & Data Science Executive

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SUMMARY

I turn visual AI research into revenue. At Vizit I operate as the company's de facto AI executive: I set the technology and product vision, run the research agenda, built the data science organization, and answer for the science in front of the executive team and Fortune 500 customers. The core IP behind every product the company sells is my work. Career proof: $35M annualized revenue (Harley-Davidson), $15M+ annual savings (Northwestern Mutual), $800K–$900K infrastructure savings (Vizit).

EXPERIENCE

Principal Data Scientist *Mar 2026 – Present*

Vizit · Boston, MA (Sr. Data Scientist Apr 2025 → Staff Sep 2025 → Principal Mar 2026)

- Report directly to the CEO. Own both R&D and Data Science with a team of **5 data scientists** spanning production ML, customer analytics, and research; final scientific check on everything the platform ships.
- Built Vizit's core IP: proprietary Visual AI models fusing product imagery with search, market, and conversion signals across thousands of categories — the foundational asset behind every product the company sells.
- Directing a complete rebuild of the core platform, delivering **$800K–$900K in infrastructure cost savings** through architecture changes and optimization.
- Built the Sales Intelligence / Competitive Insights dashboard now embedded as the default pre-sales workflow, influencing **$250K–$800K in revenue pipeline**.
- Scaled causal-inference impact studies for global consumer brands: **60 studies delivered, $186K in cost savings, 5,000+ analyst hours automated** via self-serve dashboards.
- Delivered churn-prevention analytics protecting **~$500K TCV across 9 at-risk enterprise accounts**; present and defend methodology directly to customer stakeholders.
- Drive next-gen R&D: image generation, heat-map technology for CLIP audiences, and upgraded audience modeling.

Senior Data Scientist *Dec 2021 – Apr 2025*

Northwestern Mutual · Boston, MA

- Shipped an XGBoost straight-through-processing pipeline for disability claims, cutting decision time **75% (~42 days)**; reconfigured an LLM to extract medical terms from handwritten forms (+20% precision).
- Built a churn model for financial representatives driving **$15M+ in annual savings**; created a generative-AI oversampling method (−90% noise vs. KNN-SMOTE), shipped as an internal Python package.
- Line-managed a team of junior analysts and data scientists; translated model metrics into business outcomes to drive adoption.

Data Scientist *Aug 2019 – Dec 2021*

Harley-Davidson Motor Company · Milwaukee, WI

- First data scientist hired — built the function from zero to a full team reporting insights directly to executives.
- Built a prospect-identification model (90% accuracy) generating **$35M in annualized revenue**; customer-journey analysis lifted conversion **44%**.
- Created NLP-driven desirability, LTV, sentiment, and lead/retention scores adopted as company-wide standard metrics.

Earlier Roles *2016 – 2019*

- Data Scientist, University of Oklahoma — CAD deep-learning model classifying breast masses on digital mammograms. Java Developer, Pyro Group — "Best Employee" award for dynamic web application development.

SKILLS

ML & AI: Causal Inference, A/B Testing, XGBoost, Computer Vision (CLIP, EfficientNet), LLMs & Generative AI, NLP, Deep Learning, Recommendation & Scoring Systems

Engineering: Python, SQL, Production ML Pipelines, ONNX, AWS (S3), Model Deployment & Monitoring, Snowflake

Leadership: AI Strategy & Governance, Org Design & Team Building, Executive Communication, Customer-Facing Science, P&L-Minded Prioritization

EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Science — University of Oklahoma

B.Tech Computer Science — Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University | Certifications: Machine Learning, Generative AI for Executives